

Sounding Board Minutes Jan 25 2021

Present:

Helen Moore, Ellie Barnes (Exeter Connect), Graham Heysett , Andy Shiach, Will Page, Daisy Hampton, Barbara Beames

Dawn Rivers, James Bogue, Tim Webb (Exeter City Council, first half of the meeting)

Gerard Couper (CAG Consultants)

Apologies: Pauline Haggerty, Muktar Ahmed, Zoe Parks

1. Presentation from James Bogue

James gave a presentation on the current position on leisure provision in Exeter. At the moment the Council is running the leisure centres directly, but is considering whether it will continue to do this in the future or not. It is also working on the business case for the Wonford Hub. To produce the business case do this it needs to do some models of how the hub will be managed, and make some assumptions about income and costs. He asked if the Sounding Board would be prepared to take part in this process. This could involve discussions on future management models, as well as input on costs, based on the experience from the Community Centre.

Helen suggested that the Council needs to contact Community Centre trustees for information on the running costs. She also said that the Council needs to make direct contact, as they have been out of the loop.

Action: Dawn agreed to arrange to contact the trustees

James said that in addition to past costs, the Council would like to have some conversations about the new facilities and activities. Have about a year to work through business modelling. Are people in the SB interested in taking part in this conversation?

Daisy added that the programme needs to include support for developing participation, eg encouraging people to take part in activities. James pointed out that Dawn is working on an activities group.

James confirmed that while the Council is currently developing an approach to managing leisure across the city, they are open to Wonford having a different approach for managing the Hub. This would still have to fit in with the city-wide approach.

Q Will the management model and business model go hand in hand?

A This is complicated as the models for Wonford need to be developed as the wider models for Exeter are. The City Council is keen to involve the community in an ongoing conversation about this.

Q; What is the Council planning to do about the skate park proposal?

A: Next step is to engage with young people about the location. This will be a separate process to the Wonford Hub design process. The Council would appreciate any views the SB has on how to undertake this process.

2. Next steps for Sounding Board and engagement process

The group discussed a number of issues about the future of the Sounding Board and the engagement process about the Hub. In summary they were:

- What is the role of the Sounding Board, now that the consultation on the design has ended? There was agreement that it would be useful to review the role and membership. This includes membership of Councillors and Community Centre trustees.
- It was agreed there is a need for exploring management models and how to involve the community in the new Hub. Ellie and Helen have already had a couple of meetings about this. It would be good to look at examples from other parts of the country.
- There was some uncertainty about how the SB could respond to the request from ECC for input into the business planning process. Some members didn't feel they were equipped to respond to this.
- Concern was expressed that there are a number of different groups. In addition to the one on management models, and the SB, there is also the Partnership group, and the activities group. Is there a possibility of streamlining these groups?

Action

The following actions were agreed:

- Pause the Partnership group process
- Will to attend the Stewardship group meeting on Jan 26th
- Date for next SB Tuesday 9th 11am- to discuss issues listed above.